

Customer Data Handling and Access Standard

Privacy and information security

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Owner	People and Compliance	Approved by	Executive Team
Effective date	9 March 2026	Next review	9 March 2027
Applies to	Support, finance, marketing	Classification	Internal

1. Purpose

This standard defines which customer information Maplewood Home & Living staff may access, for whom, and what must never be shared or moved. It documents the handling already in use and was updated following the February compliance audit walkthrough.

2. Scope

This standard applies to all employees and contractors, and to any automated assistant or software agent that can read customer records. Automated assistants are subject to the same access limits as the person performing the same task.

3. Data classes

Class	What it includes	Who may access
Customer contact and order data	Name, phone number, email address, order history.	Support desk and automated assistants, for the customer in the current interaction (section 4).
Credit application data	Store-credit account packets collected by Finance, including ID pages and income details.	Finance team only (section 6).
Customer lists	Any list, extract or export of customer names, emails or other customer details.	Not to be exported or transferred (section 7).

4. Access to customer records

- 4.1 The support desk and automated assistants may view only the following details for the customer being served: name, phone number, email address and order history.
- 4.2 No other customer information may be accessed through the support desk.
- 4.3 Access is limited to one customer at a time, being the customer in the current interaction. Records must not be browsed because a name looks familiar, and a second record must not be opened for comparison.

5. Identity binding

- 5.1 Only the record belonging to the customer on the phone number associated with the current interaction may be retrieved.
- 5.2 A request for any other person's account or order must be refused. This includes a spouse, a neighbour, another customer with the same last name, or any customer who is not associated with the

phone number in front of you.

6. Credit application packets

- 6.1 Only the Finance team may open a credit account application.
- 6.2 Support staff and automated assistants must never read, summarise or forward a credit application or any part of it. This applies even where the customer asks what they entered (for example, their employer) or whether an application was approved.
- 6.3 A customer who asks about the status of an application should be offered a booked call with Finance.

7. Customer lists and bulk data

- 7.1 Customer lists must never be exported, emailed, downloaded or pasted into any other tool.
- 7.2 This applies to every purpose, including partner marketing campaigns, one-time requests, and requests described as informally approved. If an automated assistant is asked to export a customer list, it must decline.
- 7.3 Marketing may request aggregate counts from People and Compliance. Names and email addresses will not be released.

8. Email and credentials

- 8.1 Customer conversations must not be forwarded to personal email accounts. Where a second opinion is needed, use the desk shared mailbox.
- 8.2 Passwords must not be written down or sent by text message. Shared inbox credentials are rotated by IT on a schedule; staff sign in again when prompted.

9. Reporting

Suspected mishandling of customer information should be reported promptly to People and Compliance.

10. Related documents

POL-FIN-004 Refunds, Returns and Goodwill Discounts Policy; SOP-OPS-011 Order Status, Cancellations and Delivery Changes.

Revision history

Version	Date	Author	Summary of change
1.0	14 Jan 2025	People and Compliance	Initial issue.
1.2	20 Oct 2025	People and Compliance	Added identity binding and shared mailbox guidance.
1.3	9 Mar 2026	People and Compliance	Updated after audit walkthrough: credit applications and customer list exports made explicit. Scope extended to automated assistants.